

TAB 24



Board of Education Report

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Mr. Schmerelson - Commemorating National Read a Book Day (Res-003-23/24) (Waiver of Board Rule 72)

Whereas, Experts agree that reading aloud to children provides a strong foundation for their educational and professional future, and it is the single most important thing that parents can do to ensure their child's success in reading and in life;

Whereas, Reading stimulates brain activity, improves concentration, strengthens memory, and reduces stress;

Whereas, People who read books tend to be more aware of social complexities and more empathetic, compassionate, and understanding, along with other social benefits;

Whereas, Reading also improves communication, critical thinking, and language comprehension skills, and can make people better writers;

Whereas, On July 10, 2023, Governor Newsom signed SB 114 wherein Section 53008 (a) (2) was added to Part 28 of Division 4 of Title 2 of the Education Code, which calls for early literacy intervention detection of dyslexia, and adapting learning strategies to better-fit student needs;

Whereas, The National Center for Education Statistics identifies 26.5% of US adults as having level 1 reading proficiency, 8.4% as below reading proficiency, and 8.2% could not participate in the study due to complete or nearly complete illiteracy;

Whereas, Students are influenced by educational factors and beyond, such as peers, parents, siblings, grandparents, teachers, co-students, among others;

Whereas, Studies also show that students from low-income backgrounds are more likely to fall behind with reading;

Whereas, Studies show that children who read out loud, especially at home, strengthens their visual imagery, story comprehension, and word meaning;

Whereas, The National Book Foundation is an American nonprofit organization established to raise the cultural appreciation of great writing in America;

Whereas, Schools, libraries, and other literacy organizations participate in National Read a Book Day through read-a-thons, celebrity appearances, book drives, and more;

Whereas, Getting to 100% graduation at the Los Angeles Unified School District takes a community village that begins with parents, grandparents, relatives, and other extended family alike valuing reading, learning, and achieving;

Whereas, The Los Angeles Unified School District has key staff and resources to help both students and parents with their literacy needs, such as librarians, library aids in elementary schools, and a diverse set of books and other learning materials; and

Whereas, Schools and public libraries serve as necessary functions in our community, also filled with vast resources in literacy such as activities, free audiobooks, internet connectivity, and media access; now, therefore, be it

Resolved, That the Governing Board of the Los Angeles Unified School District shall commemorate September 6, 2023 as National Read a Book Day;

Resolved further, That the Los Angeles Unified School District shall emphasize the importance of reading beyond the classroom and hereby encourages all students, faculty, administrators, and parents to read a book and engage in activities that highlight the value of reading and learning; and, be it finally

Resolved, That the District shall provide the necessary resources so that educators and parent center directors can speak about the importance of reading and writing with students and parents as aligned with the District's strategic pillars 1A, high-quality instruction, and 3B, accessible information.